



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Micronesia (Federated States of). I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that—you're at a really important point in life, and it's great that you're thinking carefully about your next step. In Denmark, finishing primary school (folkeskole) at 16 means you now have several different education paths to consider. The best choice depends on your interests, strengths, and long-term goals. Here's a breakdown of the main options available to you, with pros and cons to help you reflect:

1. Gymnasium (STX, HHX, HTX, HF) – General Upper Secondary Education

These are 2-3 year academic programs that prepare you for higher education.

✓ STX (Almen studentereksamen)

- Broad general education (Danish, math, sciences, humanities).
- Best if you're unsure what you want to study at university.
- Leads to university or professional degrees.

✓ HHX (Højere handelseksamen)

- Focus on business, economics, and languages.
- Good if you're interested in business, international trade, marketing, or entrepreneurship.

✓ HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)

- Focus on technology, science, IT, and engineering.
- Good for future engineers, tech enthusiasts, or health sciences.

✓ HF (Højere forberedelseeksamen)

- 2-year program, more practice-oriented and often chosen by more mature students or those who didn't follow the regular path.
- Can lead to university but not all programs.

Ideal for you if:

You enjoy academic subjects, like schoolwork, and think you might want to go to university later.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (VET – Vocational Education and Training)

These are vocational programs that combine school with hands-on work experience (apprenticeship) in a company.

Examples:

- Electrician, carpenter, mechanic
- Hairdresser, chef, baker
- IT-supporter, data technician
- Health assistant

Ideal for you if:

You prefer practical work over sitting in a classroom all day and want to start earning money and getting experience sooner.

3. EUX – A Combination of Vocational Training and Gymnasium

- Gives you both a vocational qualification and a general upper secondary degree (like STX).
- You can go directly into a job *or* university afterward.
- It's demanding, but very flexible.

Ideal for you if:

You're practical but still want the option of higher education later.

Things to Think About:

1. What are your interests?

- Do you enjoy science, business, art, working with people, or using your hands?

2. Do you want to go to university later?

- Then STX, HTX, HHX, or EUX might be the way to go.

3. Would you rather start working and earning money sooner?

- Then a vocational education (EUD) might suit you better.

4. Do you feel ready for more academic studies?

- If not, you could take a "efterskole" year or prepare through 10th grade (10. klasse) with focus on your strengths.

My Recommendation (Based on What You Shared):

Since you're fluent in Danish, born and raised in Denmark, and just finishing primary school:

- If you enjoy school and might want to go to university: **consider STX or HTX.**
 - If you like working with your hands or want real-world experience: **look into vocational education (EUD) or EUX.**
 - If you're not 100% sure: **you could try 10th grade (10. klasse)** at a local school or a **boarding efterskole**, which is great for personal development and exploring your interests.
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If you'd like, I can also help you:

- Compare specific schools near you
- Create a pros/cons list for different tracks
- Explore how your Micronesian background might give you a unique perspective in certain fields (e.g. international relations, climate studies, etc.)

What are your interests or things you enjoy doing in school or in your free time? That would help me give a more personalized suggestion.